

DR. WILDERNESS

A Documentary by Clyde Hendrickson

The pieces within are meant to be performed in any order the actors and director deem appropriate. No animals were harmed in the making of this documentary.

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Bat

TRAV. Welcome to our special presentation of, "How to survive a bat attack while bathing," with your host, Dr. Wilderness!

(*Dr. Wilderness is wearing a safari shirt. Zoom out to see he is also wearing bright orange speedos.*)

DR. WILDERNESS. Today we'll be demonstrating what to do if you're attacked by bats in your home shower. For this purpose, TJ has a grocery bag full of live fruit bats. (Show jostling bag). I will be demonstrating in my very own bathroom while taking a real shower. For your protection and mine, I will be wearing a shirt, which I do not normally wear while I bathe.

Now, the weapon of choice in this situation is a loofah on a stick. I keep one in all the showers of my house, just in case. When the bats descend upon you, hungry for the sweet nectar of your blood, calmly bat them out of the air one at a time. If you are a girl, or a stinking hippy, and have long hair, make sure to occasionally thwack it to dislodge any tangled animals.

Ok, TJ – release the bats!

(*Camera stays on DW as we hear bat release, we do not see the bats above him except when he knocks one down*)

Ok, got one… this is a lot of bats! I think – ah! THE BAT BIT ME. I thought these were friendly bats. It's a demonstration! Why are they so angry!

TRAV. Because you're hitting them with a loofah.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's a gentle tap! Ahhhhg! I'm just stunning them…. They're swarming. They're feasting on my head! It burns! My scalp is burning!

TRAV. Maybe you need a new conditioner.

DR. WILDERNESS. Maybe I need to not be attacked by bats in the shower!

TRAV. You've almost got them all…

DR. WILDERNESS. No, no, the tide is turning in their favor! It's all over! (*DW falls*) Get the bat spray. Get something. Throw a piece of meat at them or something!

(*DW is curled on a ball in the floor of the shower*)

TRAV. The bats just flew into your bedroom.

DR. WILDERNESS. Oh thank heavens… It burns, it burns... Call a doctor!

TRAV. You're a doctor.

DR. WILDERNESS. No I'm not. It's just a name! My whole life is a lie!

TRAV. (*sighs*) I'll get the bactine.

DR. WILDERNESS. And some bandaids… lots and lots of bandaids.

Malaysian Fishing Cat

DR. WILDERNESS. Hello. I'm Dr. Wilderness. Before we talk about today's animal, I'd like to take you on a tour of my ranch.

TRAV. You mean this filthy hovel.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's a ranch!

TRAV. No ranch is that dirty.

DR. WILDERNESS. You'll have to excuse my cameraman, Trav. He's still upset that he got bit by Scraps, my pet vulture.

TRAV. I'm upset that you put a dead mouse on my face so your vulture would wake me up.

DR. WILDERNESS. It made for great television.

TRAV. It was the night after my brother's funeral! And we're not on television, we're on youTube.

DR. WILDERNESS. Nevertheless, two years ago Trav decided to finish up his film degree by working on this show. Since he has to start paying his student loans when he graduates, we're not going to be wrapping up anytime soon.

TRAV. I should have let the vulture finish the job.

DR. WILDERNESS. So, this is my ranch. Over here are my fish tanks. There are no fish right now because I adopted a Malaysian Fishing Cat.

TRAV. Tell them the whole story.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's obvious. It was a fishing cat.

TRAV. It's not obvious.

DR. WILDERNESS. (sighs) I thought the cat would eat a few of the fish, keep the population down, which it did… But then it ate one of my special gold fish. That I kept swimming in a Redbull solution. Well, it ate all 73 of them. Then the cat went a bit crazy ...I didn't know cats could figure out matches.

TRAV. Or computers.

DR. WILDERNESS. This is where I keep my lizards. My first pets. Got them 30 years ago. They're only supposed to live five years. But not mine! They made it seven. I just can't bear to get rid of them. Too sentimental I guess. Also the garbage collectors stopped coming to my ranch years ago.

TRAV. After the alligator incident.

DR. WILDERNESS. So here's today's animal, the beautiful Wilson's Bird of Paradise. As you can see now, the bird is hissing, showing its claws and fangs, in a mating ritual called the lek. It seems to have grown to take up most of the cage - but that's an optical illusion caused by hormones.

TRAV. That's not an optical illusion. That's definitely a Malaysian Fishing Cat.

DR. WILDERNESS. It is? It is! Sprinkles! You came back. I'm so glad you liked the Bird of Paradise I got you.

TRAV. There is something wrong with you.

DR. WILDERNESS. Now Trav, that's not what you're supposed to say.

TRAV. (*sighs*) There is something wrong with you, Doctor.

DR. WILDERNESS. Thank you! I agree. And so does Sprinkles.

Pig

DR. WILDERNESS. Captain Bill Overbite is here with his pig, or as it was called in olden times, a magical bacon machine. What is this noble creature's name?

BILL. The pig's name is Ghandi.

DR. WILDERNESS. And if we were to slaughter Ghandi right now, how long would it be before we were eating delicious bacon?

BILL. I'm from the pet pig rescue society, so I've never considered that.

DR. WILDERNESS. Would pork chops be faster? I'm pretty hungry now.

BILL. We can't make the pig into anything.

DR. WILDERNESS. Is there something wrong with it? Poor piggie!

BILL. This pig is not going to become bacon or pork chops today.

DR. WILDERNESS. Ok. We don't have to eat it yet. Now where did you capture this pig.

BILL. We rescue them from bad owners.

DR. WILDERNESS. Oh! So are they up for adoption, like kittens.

BILL. They sure are, Dr. Wilderness.

DR. WILDERNESS. Then I would like to adopt this pig!

BILL. Are you going to eat it?

DR. WILDERNESS. Is there a way to get bacon without doing so?

BILL. That's ridiculous!

DR. WILDERNESS. You're the pig expert, you know things.

BILL. You're a doctor. You should know where bacon comes from.

DR. WILDERNESS. I am a doctor, I thank you for acknowledging it. Certainly I know where bacon comes from. The poppa bacon falls in love with a mama bacon, and then they hug very tightly...

BILL. Come on, Ghandi, let's go.

DR. WILDERNESS. Sorry you don't like bacon porn down at the pig rescue society! That's it for today, folks. I'm Dr. Wilderness. Stay Wild, America!

Anteater

TRAV. What are you doing?

DR. WILDERNESS. There were a lot more M&M's in this bowl.

TRAV. You probably got drunk and ate some.

DR. WILDERNESS. No, something's fishy...

TRAV. You got drunk and fed them to the fish!

DR. WILDERNESS. Ah hah! All the brown ones are gone. Only colors remain.

TRAV. Wow. Startling. You got drunk and ate all the brown M&M's.

DR. WILDERNESS. We may never know. Oh look, it's Hoover the anteater. Hello Hoover.

(*He picks up the anteater, which is kicking furiously.*)

DR. WILDERNESS. When really angry, the common anteater will vomit a chocolatey substance on the nearest face.

TRAV. I'm covered in brown M&M regurgitate because your stupid anteater thought the brown M&M's were ants. Because like all animals it is so stupid.

DR. WILDERNESS. I think this anteater may be possessed. In our next episode, we will have it exorcised. The power of christ compels you! (*The anteater throws up on him*).

Turtle

What beast are we staring at in this scientific kiddie pool, Doctor?

LAURA. It's a Green Sea Turtle.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's a Green Sea Turtle, Doctor.

LAURA. Yes, that's what I just told you.

DR. WILDERNESS. No, no. I'd like you to call me doctor.

LAURA. Ok, Doctor.

DR. WILDERNESS. My pants grow tight as I stare at this majestic sea turtle.

LAURA. It was injured off Key West by fishing line.

DR. WILDERNESS. It looks like a dinosaur. Some would say the sea turtle IS a dinosaur. Is that correct?

LAURA. Absolutely not, Doctor.

DR. WILDERNESS. Do you think it wishes it was a dinosaur, Doctor?

LAURA. No.

DR. WILDERNESS. Do you wish you were a dinosaur sometimes?

LAURA. I haven't thought about it.

DR. WILDERNESS. Haven't thought about it! How did you become a doctor?

LAURA. Hard work and studying.

DR. WILDERNESS. Sometimes, after a hard day staring at animals and making snarky comments about them, I ask myself, maybe it would all be easier if I wasn't a doctor, and was just a dinosaur. Then I could just eat the animals.

LAURA. That's pretty ferocious.

DR. WILDERNESS. That's pretty ferocious, doctor.

LAURA. Doctor Wilderness, please.

DR. WILDERNESS. Yes, Laura?

LAURA. Could you call me Doctor?

DR. WILDERNESS. I'm not sure. Does the turtle have any natural predators?

LAURA. Sharks!

DR. WILDERNESS. Oh whatever, Sharks are everybody's natural predator. That doesn't count. What about unnatural predators? Like a cyborg octopus. With lasers. Do sea turtles fight cyborg octopuses? Excuse me, cyborg octopi.

LAURA. I do not know what you are talking about.

DR. WILDERNESS. I'm talking about turtle space battles. Which should be something you know about, Doctor. As my favorite book, *Eat, Pray, Love*, says, "Know thyself."

LAURA. Not sure it says that.

DR. WILDERNESS. It does. I crossed out the words, wrote that, and then drew pictures of myself riding dinosaurs.

LAURA. Could you please just tell your viewers to donate to our cause?

DR. WILDERNESS. I will as soon as we get some.

Snake

TRAV. Dr. Wilderness! Dr. Wilderness! You're needed right away! It's an emergency.

DR. WILDERNESS. An emergency! Is there a lemur stuck in a well?

TRAV. No, lemurs aren't stupid, only kids get stuck in wells. Just come quick!

DR. WILDERNESS. Let me put on my pants!

TRAV. But, Doctor!

DR. WILDERNESS. What is it?

TRAV. You burned all your pants when you were drunk last night.

DR. WILDERNESS. Well gosh darnit man, give me yours!

TRAV. …No.

DR. WILDERNESS. There's no time. Saddle up my alpaca.

TRAV. But the emergency is literally outside your house.

DR. WILDERNESS. Saddle the alpaca anyway. Let's go!

(*Cut to outside*.)

TRAV. This woman dropped her purse down the storm gate.

WOMAN. Please help me!

DR. WILDERNESS. Say the magic word.

WOMAN. I said please.

DR. WILDERNESS. Call me doctor.

DR. WILDERNESS. Please help me, Doctor!

DR. WILDERNESS. Nope, still didn't work, even with the magic word.

TRAV. She needs her medicine in her purse! But it's 8 feet down there.

DR. WILDERNESS. Ok.

TRAV. Help her!

DR. WILDERNESS. This is my problem… how?

TRAV. She's going to die without her medicine. Outside your shack.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's a ranch.

TRAV. We've got to get it the medicine.

DR. WILDERNESS. It's not animal related. I'm kind of an animal problem specialist. You know, like on my TV show.

TRAV. YouTube show. Yes. But, can't you do something for her.

DR. WILDERNESS. Hold on. Here's my trusty python sidekick, Leviticus. He will slink down through the grate and grasp the purse in his mighty jaws.

WOMAN. He's trained for that.

DR. WILDERNESS. Sort of. He might eat the purse. So either we'll get it now, or in about… 30 days.

TRAV. You should call the police.

WOMAN. For my medicine.

TRAV. Yes. And an ambulance.

WOMAN. Why?

DR. WILDERNESS. Yes, wh----URKKKK

(*The python is slowly squeezing DW to death.*)

TRAV. It happens every time.

Guinea Pig

DR. WILDERNESS. Mr. Carl Montague, Did you capture this guinea pig in the wild?

CARL. No, actually, Guinea pigs don't come from the wild. They are called cavies in the wild. You have to buy a domesticated guinea pig from a breeder or the store.

DR. WILDERNESS. I didn't know they had a store for ferocious wild animals. Besides Abercrombie, I mean.

CARL. It's not a wild animal. It's domesticated.

DR. WILDERNESS. I was a little afraid of it attacking me, so I wore this mustache to confuse it.

CARL. Is that a Hitler mustache?

DR. WILDERNESS. Please, Mr. Montague, the variety of mustaches they sell at the sex shop next to my local 7-11 are not what we're talking about. We're talking about whether that Guinea Pig has or will ripped anyone's face off.

CARL. It has not.

DR. WILDERNESS. But it will.

CARL. I suppose it could... if you had a really sensitive face.

DR. WILDERNESS. My father had a weak face. He died from it.

CARL. Mr. Nacho won't hurt you.

DR. WILDERNESS. Mr. Nacho!?

CARL. That's his name.

DR. WILDERNESS. My mother choked to death on a nacho! Just saying the word Nacho can give me hives! (*He begins itching furiously*.) It's all over! Oh no... (*He stands up, pulls down his pants*.) Carl! Is there a rash appearing on my buttocks?

CARL. I... what? Hives on your butt?

DR. WILDERNESS. That's where phase 2 usually begins. My psychosomatic nacho reaction is fixated on my butt. Now please get him out of here.

CARL. Ok, come here Mr. Nacho, we're - oh, crap.

DR. WILDERNESS. What?

CARL. I guess in all the commotion, he got loose.

DR. WILDERNESS. In my house? (*He is white with fear*.) I'll never be able to sit down again...

Bear

TRAV. And now, Dr. Wilderness meets a bear!

DR. WILDERNESS. I never thought we'd get this close to a bear. The noble mother is out with her cub... I'll just try and pet the cub, it's so cute!

(*There is 30 seconds of chaos and screaming. Feel free to improv whatever you like. Trav is definitely attacked as well*.)

Weasels

DR. WILDERNESS. Today, we're throwing a bunch of live, hungry weasels into a bar to watch the drunk people go crazy. Hand me my sack of weasels.

TRAV. Here is your sack.

DR. WILDERNESS. Was that a joke about my balls? My balls are very big.

TRAV. Ball. You have one ball.

DR. WILDERNESS. Fine, but I lost it in a battle with a jaguar.

TRAV. You lost it fleeing a jaguar kitten when you jumped off a second story balcony and landed on a sprinkler.

DR. WILDERNESS. The kittens can get on your face. Do you want a jaguar on your face?

TRAV. No…

DR. WILDERNESS. How bout a SPIDER! (*He throws a bag, but nothing comes out*) Why is my tarantula bag empty? I told you to load it.

TRAV. You only load it to throw it at people, so, no.

DR. WILDERNESS. Ok, animal lovers, it's time to get back to nature, where weasel ambus attacks are a fact of life. (*He opens the door and throws in the weasels*) Away weasels! Now we wait.

(*Silence*)

TRAV. Do you hear children screaming?

DR. WILDERNESS. There aren't any children in a bar.

TRAV. It's a pizza place that serves beer. It's 11 o'clock on a Saturday morning.

DR. WILDERNESS. Nuts. Dr. Wilderness to the rescue.

TRAV. (*to camera*) He definitely did this on purpose.

DR. WILDERNESS. (*Running out, screaming*) The weasels have feasted upon pizza and children's tears. They want nothing but blood! Revenge my death.

TRAV. I wonder if they ate *all* the pizza...

Swedish Beaver, Pt. 1

DR. WILDERNESS. Are we in focus?

TRAV. No.

DR. WILDERNESS. Why not?

TRAV. Because I'm drunk.

DR. WILDERNESS. I told you not to have that 3rd Bloody Mary on the plane.

TRAV. You're not the boss of me.

DR. WILDERNESS. I am.

TRAV. You're the boss of Trav. I'm drunk Trav. I answer to no one. No one!!! (He hears something) What was that? Hello?

DR. WILDERNESS. It was you screaming.

TRAV. Ahhhhh!!!!! (*Listens*.) Yes it was.

DR. WILDERNESS. Are we rolling?

TRAV. We got all that in HD.

DR. WILDERNESS. (*To camera*) After a long, arduous journey on a crappy airline, I am in Sweden. I actually cashed in my 401k from working at Bob's Exotic Pets, I sold my anaconda Levticus, to film this special. Sweden, it seems, is plagued with beavers. Mean, mean beavers. They come sprinting out of the woods, like a furry poltergeists, eyes flaring an empty white like an angry grandmother. They latch onto your leg with their steel jaws and they bite, bite, bite, until you are disabled. Then they scamper happily away. Beavers think they own Sweden. Most nature shows would come here to document the phenomenon. I'm here to stop it. Let's talk to a man on the street. (He approaches a Swedish man) Excuse me, sir?

SWEDISH MAN 1. Yah?

DR. WILDERNESS. Have you ever been attacked by a badger?

SWEDISH MAN 1. Badger?

DR. WILDERNESS. Yes, a little brown furry pointy mean bitey thing?

SWEDISH MAN 1. Bitey? Bitey? (*Realizes*) BÄVER! BÄVERRRR BITEY!!!! (*Wild with fear, he shakes Dr. Wilderness*)

DR. WILDERNESS. He doesn't understand. I must not be getting through to them.

Swedish Beaver, Pt. 2

DR. WILDERNESS. Let's try this again. Hello, Ma'am, have you met...

SWEDISH WOMAN 1. BÄVER!!!!

DR. WILDERNESS. My giant Beaver costume is working. I'll run after her and see if I can learn more. Ma'am! Ma'am! Are you attacked by beavers frequently? What would you do if one was running down the street after you?

(*He catches up to her and corner her*)

DR. WILDERNESS. I'm just looking for information. Tell me about the beaver!

SWEDISH WOMAN 1. (*crouching in corner, crying*) No, no, no...

DR. WILDERNESS. My god. The beavers must have really scarred these people. This woman can't even talk. Something horrible must have happened.

Swedish Beaver, Pt. 3

TRAV. Why are we out here again?

DR. WILDERNESS. We need some good shots of me in the snow.

TRAV. My god, did we really have to walk 3 miles into the woods while it's snowing to film this? There's snow everywhere!

Dr. Wilderness is taking back Sweden… for the SWISS.

TRAV. The Swedish?

DR. WILDERNESS. No, it's swiss. Swiss Badgers, like Swiss Chocolates, right?

TRAV. What about the Swedish chef?

DR. WILDERNESS. No, see, that was a joke, because the muppets were a racist conspi - OH MY GOD A BEAVER IS HEADED RIGHT FOR YOU!

TRAV. Ah! He's got me! He's got me! Help Dr. Wilderness!

DR. WILDERNESS. (*grabs camera*) You can see, the beaver is relentless. He is going to gnaw straight through to the bone. Look at the blood!

TRAV. Stop filming and get me some help!.

DR. WILDERNESS. No, Trav. You never gave into weakness for my sake. You never went for help - you always just filmed the suffering. Like you should.

TRAV. No, no, it wasn't brave! I was just being a dick! Oh for the love of big bird this beaver is so strong. I'd rather have ball cancer again.

DR. WILDERNESS. You had ball cancer?

TRAV. I did.

DR. WILDERNESS. You never told me.

TRAV. I was gone for two years!

DR. WILDERNESS. I thought you just hated me.

TRAV. I love you, Dr. Wilderness.

DR. WILDERNESS. I know. (*He takes out a branch*) Snapping a branch near the badger will make them leave - the sound tricks them into thinking the bone is broken. (He snaps it) Their mission accomplished, they scamper off.

TRAV. Goodbye, Beaver! Hello, Post Traumatic Stress Syndrome.

DR. WILDERNESS. We should get you some first aid.

TRAV. Possibly.

DR. WILDERNESS. That was a big beaver.

TRAV. Actually, it was a wolf.

DR. WILDERNESS. Oh.

TRAV. I couldn't tell you in the moment. You were so excited.

DR. WILDERNESS. Also I needed to focus on fighting the beaver. Wolf. The beaverwolf.

TRAV. Yes.

DR. WILDERNESS. So we'll never see a beaver.

TRAV. They killed the beavers around here, because one of them bit a child. A dozen or so.

DR. WILDERNESS. A dozen or so children?

TRAV. No, beavers. Were killed.

DR. WILDERNESS. My god. That's so sad. (*weeping*)

TRAV. Awww... hey, cheer up, there's a fjord.

DR. WILDERNESS. A fjord?

TRAV. Yeah, two of them.

DR. WILDERNESS. I thought fjords were long, narrow inlets with steep sides, created in a valley carved by glacial activity. Those look like two dead trees.

TRAV. They're definitely two whole fjords. Double fjords.

DR. WILDERNESS. Oh my god! Double fjords! Double fjords at the site of my greatest victory! Haha! What does this mean?

TRAV. It means you've conquered Sweden.

DR. WILDERNESS. And I shall never let them deal with a beaver unjustly again! This is Dr. Wilderness, new king of the Swiss, signing off.